

illustrations have the extension .ai, Photoshop .ps and audio files have a lot of different extensions that you can store under different folders as well.

The folder containing pre-compositions will be slightly less complicated as it will just contain a bunch of pre-comps and nothing else. No sub folders as there's no need for them. This is just the way I prefer to do it and the truth is that there is no one correct way to do it. Try out a few different things and see what suits your style, after all systems and habits maketh a man.

Importing a file with multiple layers will produce a new dialog box, for example, Photoshop and Illustrator files which will already have multiple layers of previously worked on material. So in these cases, Adobe After Effects will ask you how you would like the file to be imported, either as footage (where you won't have the flexibility to work with the layers), as a Composition or as a Composition where you can retain layer sizes. Choose this according to your need, though in most cases, unless you're absolutely sure you don't need access to individual layers, import as a composition with layer sizes retained.

With some of the files like a Photoshop file, you will not be able to directly edit the text. There is a work around to this though. Once you import it into the timeline panel, right click and in the Create menu, click on 'Convert to Editable Text'. You will notice that the file icon changes to a Text icon (from the previous Photoshop icon) and that the text is now editable.

LINKING

A very intriguing aspect of the import function in AE is that the element is linked to both the location of the original file and the name of the source file. To put it more plainly, an element in AE is intrinsically linked to the file location and original file name. The elements aren't actual objects present in AE but rather they are represented by links in the Project panel.

There are a couple of major implications to this (when the object in question has already been imported)



An error dialog box saying the file could not be found